

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in procedural document management, deadline tracking, evidence review and case-file organisation at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. Comfortable working with large volumes of documentation in regulated, time-sensitive environments. Strong legal research and written communication skills, with experience translating complex regulatory requirements into clear, organised output.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and regulatory compliance) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme, Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets filing deadlines across a concurrent caseload
- Takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies evidential gaps across welfare, employment, housing and debt matters
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; researches complex procedural points and advises clients on requirements and options
- Translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for clients unfamiliar with legal processes

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial in a complex investment arbitration
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial under supervision
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files; monitored procedural deadlines across the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated external translations with a Romanian translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and supported court filings, hearing arrangements and matter opening and closure
- Reviewed documents and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials across several concurrent matters
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents under competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage
- Tracked deadlines and cost comparisons; conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements and landlord and tenant disputes

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, including children's personal data and adtech
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet deadlines

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed data-processing and confidentiality provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; document review; electronic bundling; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems; concise report writing

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters